

Adaora Mbanefo

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EDUCATION

University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign

Bachelor of Science | Majors: Statistics, Linguistics, Actuarial Science | Minors: Computer Science

Overall GPA: 3.79

Champaign, IL

May 2028

Relevant Coursework: Probability, Mathematical Statistics, Statistical Modeling, Applied Machine Learning, Statistical Learning, Linear Algebra, Data Structures, Computer Systems, Computational Linguistics

EXPERIENCE

ChatterLab, University of Chicago

Research Assistant

Chicago, IL

June 2026 – August 2026

- Detecting children's entry into multiparty conversation in naturalistic home recordings, using drops in linguistic alignment to mark interaction boundaries
- Building alignment pipelines in ALIGN 2.0 (Python) and an ELAN preprocessing converter to move the analysis onto real daylong audio
- Presenting this research at the ICIS Founding Generation Symposium, September 2026

Learning and Language Lab, University of Illinois

Research Assistant

Champaign, IL

August 2025 – May 2026

- Developed transformer-based model in PyTorch combining visual, linguistic, and BERT-derived features to predict eye-movement patterns
- Expanded and curated eye-tracking corpus from 225k to 800k+ word fixations across skilled readers
- Engineered Python pipelines to extract, quantify, and visualize naturalistic caregiver-child interactions; presented findings on question-elicited speech at the UIUC Undergraduate Research Symposium

Inhance Supply Chain Solutions

Data Science Intern

Johannesburg, South Africa

June 2025 – August 2025

- Built automated Python forecasting pipeline using Darts and StatsForecast for time-series preprocessing and modeling
- Integrated forecasting system with AWS Redshift and Lambda for real-time execution, deploying to 400+ warehouses

Adanian Labs, Artificial Intelligence Center of Excellence

Artificial Intelligence Engineering Intern

Nairobi, Kenya

July 2024 – October 2024

- Co-designed Mwalimu AI, an AI-powered CBC curriculum planner for Kenyan educators using Python
- Fine-tuned the Agricare chatbot backend services, increasing response accuracy by 20%

LEADERSHIP AND VOLUNTEERING

Littafin Fasaha

Learning Engine & Interactive Coding Contributor

Remote

May 2026 – Present

- Fine-tune large language models to deliver interactive computer science instruction in Hausa and other underrepresented African languages
- Build full-stack features for learning platform in React/Next.js (TypeScript) with a Supabase/SQL backend
- Develop front-end components that integrate model outputs into the user-facing interface, walking students through

National Center for Supercomputing Applications (NCSA)

Research Conference Committee Industry Networking Lead

Champaign, IL

October 2025 – April 2026

- Coordinated with NCSA Industry Program and university partners to identify and invite industry participants
- Developed panel questions to align with the 2026 conference theme
- Moderated and led industry panel discussions, facilitating structured and professional dialogue

HM Pitje Foundation

Project Manager, Advisory Board, Volunteer

Johannesburg, South Africa

July 2022 – Present

- Organized book drives raising \$3,000+ and supporting digital skills training for 500+ youth in Soshanguve

SKILLS

Technical: Python, C/C++, Java, Swift, PyTorch/TensorFlow, Hugging Face, scikit-learn, spaCy, Flutter, Dart, Git, Excel

Languages: English (fluent), French (fluent), Sesotho (fluent), Mandarin (intermediate)